

THIS WEEK POURED BY **RIVERSIDE WINE & SPIRITS** · SAMPLE SPONSOR

EAT WELL · DRINK WELL · CHATTANOOGA

Mise en Place

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THE MISE

One hundred twenty-six Wednesdays. I've now poured for, eaten with, and pestered enough of you that strangers stop me at the Market to argue about chili dogs. I'll take it.

This week: the chopped wiener that's been perfect since 1966, a coffee roaster worth setting an alarm for, a postcard from the bourbon trail, and the wine I'm chilling for the heat that won't quit. Plus Supper Club No. 19 — and yes, No. 18 sold out in nine minutes, so read to the bottom. Bibs on.

— **[Your Name]**, *who still can't drive past Memo's without stopping*

THE PLATE

Memo's chopped wiener, and the genius of never changing

There's a school of cooking that wins medals, and there's a school that just gets it *exactly right*, every time, for sixty years. **Memo's Grill** on East MLK is the second kind. The chopped-wiener plate — dogs under a thick, dark chili, slaw, mustard, onions, on a toasted bun with no business holding together but doing it anyway — is one of the great Chattanooga plates, full stop. Since 1966. No reinvention, no deconstruction; a single idea executed with the muscle memory of ten thousand lunches.

Somebody else in this town will tell you what the chili *means*. I'll tell you to beat the noon line and order two.

THE POUR · *my pick this week*

I'm still chilling **cru Beaujolais** — Morgon, Fleurie, whatever your shop has cold. Gamay, lightly chilled, is the most food-friendly red on earth and the only thing I want next to a chili dog or anything off the grill. Ask Imbibe or Riverside for one under \$25 and don't overthink it. **No-proof table:** a bone-dry cider does the same job — fruit, acid, fizz — and nobody at the cookout will blink.

THE COUNTER · THE CRAFT BEHIND IT

The table starts at breakfast: a morning with Velo

Mise en Place is a table, and the table starts before the wine does. **Velo Coffee** has been roasting in Chattanooga long enough to be its own verb around here. Roasting is invisible craft until it isn't — too dark and it's ash, too light and it's grass; the good roaster lives in the ten-second window between, reading the crack of the bean by ear. Buy a bag of the house roast, grind it that morning, and you'll taste the difference between coffee and *Coffee*. That's the whole beat of this newsletter in one cup: someone got it exactly right, and most people walked past it.

FROM THE SOURCE · POSTCARD FROM KENTUCKY

Spent the long weekend on the bourbon trail finishing the **Executive Bourbon Steward** course at Moonshine University in Louisville. Yes, it's a real credential; yes, the homework is drinking; yes, it's harder than that sounds. Full dispatch — and the three distilleries worth your own trip — next week. The one thing to steal today: at a tasting, add a *few drops of water* to a high-proof pour and watch it bloom. Costs nothing, changes everything.

WHAT'S NEW & WHAT TO ORDER

Worth knowing: Chattanooga Whiskey was named Whisky Magazine's **2026 Craft Producer of the Year** — earned; their experimental single-batch releases are the most interesting whiskey made in this city in a century. Stop in for the distillery flight and let them pour you something weird.

Order this: a wedge run from **Bleu Fox** for the weekend board — something soft, something sharp, something blue. Tell Jesse what you're drinking and let him build it; that's the move, and it's free advice from a Certified Cheese Professional.

SUPPER CLUB NO. 19 · MEMBERS FIRST

Beaujolais & Burgers — a five-course argument that the best wine pairing in town costs \$22. A chef's kitchen + a shop's cellar, 28 seats. **Members claim the first 28 Thursday 10a; everyone else Friday.** No. 18 sold out in nine minutes — be ready. (*MeP's own event — illustrative here.*)

ALSO ON THE CALENDAR

- | | |
|--------|--|
| Sep 19 | Chatta Town Tasting Festival — Chattanooga Green. Free entry; pours \$1–\$10. |
| Sep 26 | Bacon & Barrel — food & whiskey festival, First Horizon Pavilion. |

Oct 17–18 **Chattanooga Oktoberfest** — First Horizon Pavilion. Free; 99+ local & seasonal beers.

YOU WROTE IN

Three of you wrote to defend a certain east-side meat-and-three's pimento cheese as superior to anything on a board. Fighting words. We're settling it at a future Supper Club — bring your own jar, we'll judge blind. (*Reader mail — illustrative.*)

HOW MEP IS FUNDED (SAMPLE PLACEMENTS)

Presenting sponsor (a rotating bottle shop) · **Supper Club partner** (this month's host kitchen) · **The Good Kinsmen** cookware. Every placement labeled; the picks above are never for sale.

Mise en Place

Members get the first seats at every Supper Club. [Become a member](#) →

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Sister publication: The Scenic City Insider (no ads, ever).